

Whoever gives anything to the disciples of Zaratûšt, his reward and recompense are just as though the thing had been given by him to Zaratûšt.

From the same book (p. 266) we may quote for its resemblance to many Biblical passages,

Let no one practise ill-perpetrated deeds, even though in a wilderness when far from publicity, nor in distress, O Spîtâmân! because Aûharmazd, the observer of everything, is aware of them.

In the *Bahman. Yašt* (*SBE*, v. 197) we have something like the story of Dives and Lazarus:

I have seen a celebrity with much wealth, whose soul, infamous in the body, was hungry and jaundiced and in hell, and he did not seem to me exalted; and I saw a beggar with no wealth and helpless, and his soul was thriving in paradise, and he seemed to me exalted.

And in the same book (p. 203) there is a closer parallel with Micah 7⁶ (Matt. 10³⁶ f.):

And at that time, O Zaratûšt the Spîtâmân! all men will become deceivers, great friends will become of different parties, and respect, affection, hope, and regard for the soul will depart from the world; the affection of the father will depart from the son; and that of the brother from his brother; the son-in-law will become a beggar from his father-in-law, and the mother will be parted and estranged from the daughter.

It will be allowed that these parallels have not much of a moral either way, but they are perhaps sufficiently interesting to warrant quoting. There are doubtless others to be found for the trouble of searching: we must turn to more important matters.

I think I may claim to have presented a sufficient amount of manifestly fortuitous coincidence to justify